

MPAS-URBAN QUICKSTART | GUIDE 3 OF 3

Run the HRAIN2025 case

Prepare the run directory, apply the 500 m mesh setting, and optionally use the HRAIN2025 NTDK cutoff modification.

OUTCOME You will launch the three-day HRAIN2025 atmosphere experiment and understand which settings are standard, case-specific, or required only for comparison with existing historical results.

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Before you begin

Complete the recommended official MPAS tutorial and Guides 1–2. Confirm that the initial-condition file and `hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.112` exist.

Choose the executable deliberately: standard `hkust-dev` for normal MPAS-Urban learning and new experiments, or the verified HRAIN2025 case-specific commit

`57b42fa1d7649117bbf28a69c47697ea8756d268` for direct historical-result comparison and the optional 10 km CU cutoff. The latter also includes the HRAIN2025 ZT compatibility setting.

Step 1 | Prepare the run directory

FILES

```
export MPAS_SRC="$HOME/MPAS/HKUST-MPAS"
# For the HRAIN2025 comparison/cutoff source, use instead:
# export MPAS_SRC="$HOME/MPAS/HKUST-MPAS-NTDK"

export HRAIN_REPO="$HOME/HRAIN2025"
export CASE="$HOME/MPAS_CASES/HRAIN2025_30km_500m"

test -d "$CASE"
cd "$CASE"

ln -sf "$MPAS_SRC/atmosphere_model" .
cp "$HRAIN_REPO/config/namelist.atmosphere" .
cp "$MPAS_SRC/streams.atmosphere" .
ln -sf "$MPAS_SRC/default_inputs/stream_list.atmosphere.*" .
ln -sf "$MPAS_SRC/src/core_atmosphere/physics/physics_wrf/files/*TBL" .
ln -sf "$MPAS_SRC/src/core_atmosphere/physics/physics_wrf/files/*DATA*" .
ln -sf "$MPAS_SRC/src/core_atmosphere/physics/physics_noahmp/parameters/*TBL" .

ls -lh atmosphere_model namelist.atmosphere streams.atmosphere \
    30km_500m.init.nc hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.112
```

The explicit stream-list, lookup-table, and data links mirror the MPAS build/run setup. They are listed here even if an earlier tutorial step or local installation has already created them.

Step 2 | Set the case time and mesh scale

REFERENCE NAMELIST

<https://github.com/Liuzh223/HRAIN2025/blob/main/config/namelist.atmosphere>

FILE TO EDIT `namelist.atmosphere`. Copy the repository version into the run directory and verify the following fields before launch.

CHANGE 1 - `config_start_time`: the first model time is 2025-08-03_00:00:00.

CHANGE 2 - `config_run_duration`: 3_00:00:00 covers the complete three-day case; the commented three-hour value is only a smoke test.

CHANGE 3 - `config_dt`: 6 seconds is the dynamics time step used by this experiment.

CHANGE 4 - `config_len_disp`: explicitly set 500.0 here in the running namelist. This is the first point in the tutorial where this case parameter is introduced.

NAMELIST.ATMOSPHERE

```
&nhyd_model
  config_start_time = '2025-08-03_00:00:00'
  config_run_duration = '3_00:00:00'
  config_dt         = 6
  config_len_disp   = 500.0
/
```

REQUIRED CASE SETTING Keep `config_len_disp = 500.0`. It explicitly records the 500 m minimum mesh spacing used by this experiment and should not be omitted even when the mesh contains `nominalMinDc`.

Step 3 | Set the physics schemes and optional cutoff

FILE TO EDIT Continue editing the `&physics` group in `namelist.atmosphere`. The following suite is the explicit HRAIN2025 case configuration; verify every value rather than relying on source-tree defaults.

Physics suite used by HRAIN2025

The case uses WSM6 microphysics, New Tiedtke cumulus, Noah-MP land surface, YSU boundary layer and gravity-wave-drag options, cloud fraction, RRTMG longwave and shortwave radiation, the revised Monin-Obukhov surface layer, and MPAS-Urban. Use the same suite with either source tree; the standard `hkust-dev` build omits `config_cu_disable_dx`.

```
&physics
  config_microp_scheme = 'mp_wsm6'
  config_convection_scheme = 'cu_ntiedtke'
  config_lsm_scheme = 'sf_noahmp'
  config_pbl_scheme = 'bl_ysu'
  config_gwdo_scheme = 'bl_ysu_gwdo'
  config_radtcld_scheme = 'cld_fraction'
  config_radtlw_scheme = 'rrtmg_lw'
  config_radtsw_scheme = 'rrtmg_sw'
  config_sfclayer_scheme = 'sf_monin_obukhov_rev'
  config_urban_physics = true
/
```

Optional HRAIN2025 cutoff derivative

Use the following only when atmosphere_model was compiled from the verified HRAIN2025 case-specific commit 57b42fa1d7649117bbf28a69c47697ea8756d268 on Liuzh223/HKUST-MPAS-Official branch ntdk-grid-cutoff.

```
&physics
  config_convection_scheme = 'cu_ntiedtke'
  config_cu_disable_dx      = 10000.0
/
```

The value 10000.0 is a 10 km grid-spacing threshold. New Tiedtke convection is disabled where the local mesh spacing is below 10 km. The option default is 0.0, which leaves the cutoff disabled.

SOURCE NOTE ntdk-grid-cutoff is a case-author derivative, not the official HKUST-MPAS main branch. The verified case commit is <https://github.com/Liuzh223/HKUST-MPAS-Official/commit/57b42fa1d7649117bbf28a69c47697ea8756d268>. There is no separate shell command named cutoff.

Step 4 | Check the decomposition and streams

CHANGE 1 - namelist.atmosphere/&decomposition: use the prefix hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part. and launch 112 MPI tasks.

```
&decomposition
  config_block_decomp_file_prefix =
    'hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.'
/
```

Use 112 MPI tasks so that the prefix resolves to hk_hull_500m_graph.info.part.112. In streams.atmosphere, point the input stream to the initial-condition file created in Guide 2 and select the desired output interval.

FILE TO EDIT streams.atmosphere. Set the input filename to 30km_500m.init.nc, choose the history filename and output interval, and verify that all relative paths are resolved from the run directory.

Step 5 | Run and monitor

RUN

```
cd "$CASE"
export OMP_NUM_THREADS=1

mpiexec -n 112 ./atmosphere_model
```

CHECK

```
tail -n 60 log.atmosphere.0000.out
ls -lh history.*.nc 2>/dev/null || ls -lh *.nc
```

For an inexpensive first check, temporarily use a short config_run_duration, confirm that output is created, and then restore the intended three-day duration. Do not describe the short smoke test as the HRAIN2025 experiment result.

Final note | Comparing with existing HRAIN2025 results

The HRAIN2025 historical experiment results have not yet been publicly released. This section is needed only for a future direct comparison with those existing results. It is not required for learning MPAS or for a new independent simulation.

Use the verified HRAIN2025 case-specific source commit: <https://github.com/Liuzh223/HKUST-MPAS-Official/commit/57b42fa1d7649117bbf28a69c47697ea8756d268>. This single source contains both the 10 km CU cutoff and the HRAIN2025 ZT compatibility setting; the rainfall branch is not required.

SOURCE FILE

```
src/core_atmosphere/physics/physics_wrf/module_sf_urban.F
```

Inside SFCDIF_URB, the case-specific source has two active ZT updates: one after USTAR is calculated and one inside the stability iteration. The behavior originates from upstream HKUST-MPAS commit 562bdb4e5ef63527496b6374d52def06a01a84a0: <https://github.com/HKUST-MPAS/HKUST-MPAS/commit/562bdb4e5ef63527496b6374d52def06a01a84a0>. Z0 is the momentum roughness length and ZT is the thermal roughness length; this setting does not redefine or recalculate Z0.

$$ZT = 0.1 * Z0$$

The verified case-specific commit already includes both active $ZT = 0.1 * Z0$ assignments, so no manual source edit is needed. Check out the exact commit and rebuild atmosphere_model. Do not confuse this with $Z0HC_TBL = 0.1 * Z0C_TBL$, which is a different calculation.

For a new independent experiment, keep the ZT implementation supplied by the selected HKUST-MPAS version and record the repository, branch, and commit. Do not modify ZT merely to complete the tutorial.

Completion checklist

- config_start_time is 2025-08-03_00:00:00.
- config_run_duration is 3_00:00:00 for the full experiment.
- config_len_disp is explicitly 500.0.
- config_cu_disable_dx is present only for a verified cutoff-capable build and is 10000.0 for this case.
- The MPI task count matches .part.112.
- For direct comparison with the existing HRAIN2025 historical results, use the exact case-specific commit above. It already contains the CU cutoff and ZT compatibility setting; no rainfall-branch checkout or manual source edit is required.